This hearty vegetarian soup has just a touch of spice and is quick and easy to prepare. Serve with plain, low-fat yogurt and good crusty bread.

lentil soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 35 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

1 tbsp olive oil
2 onions, finely chopped
2 celery ribs, finely chopped
2 carrots, finely chopped
2 garlic cloves, crushed
1–2 tsp curry powder
5½oz (150g) red lentils
1½ quarts (1½ liters) vegetable stock
½ cup tomato or vegetable juice
salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 Heat the oil in a large pan over medium heat, then add the onions, celery, and carrots. Cook, stirring, for 5 minutes, or until the onions are soft and translucent.

2 Add the garlic and curry powder and cook, stirring, for another minute, then add the lentils, stock, and tomato juice.

3 Bring to a boil, then lower the heat, cover, and simmer for 25 minutes, or until the vegetables are tender. Season to taste with salt and pepper, and serve hot.